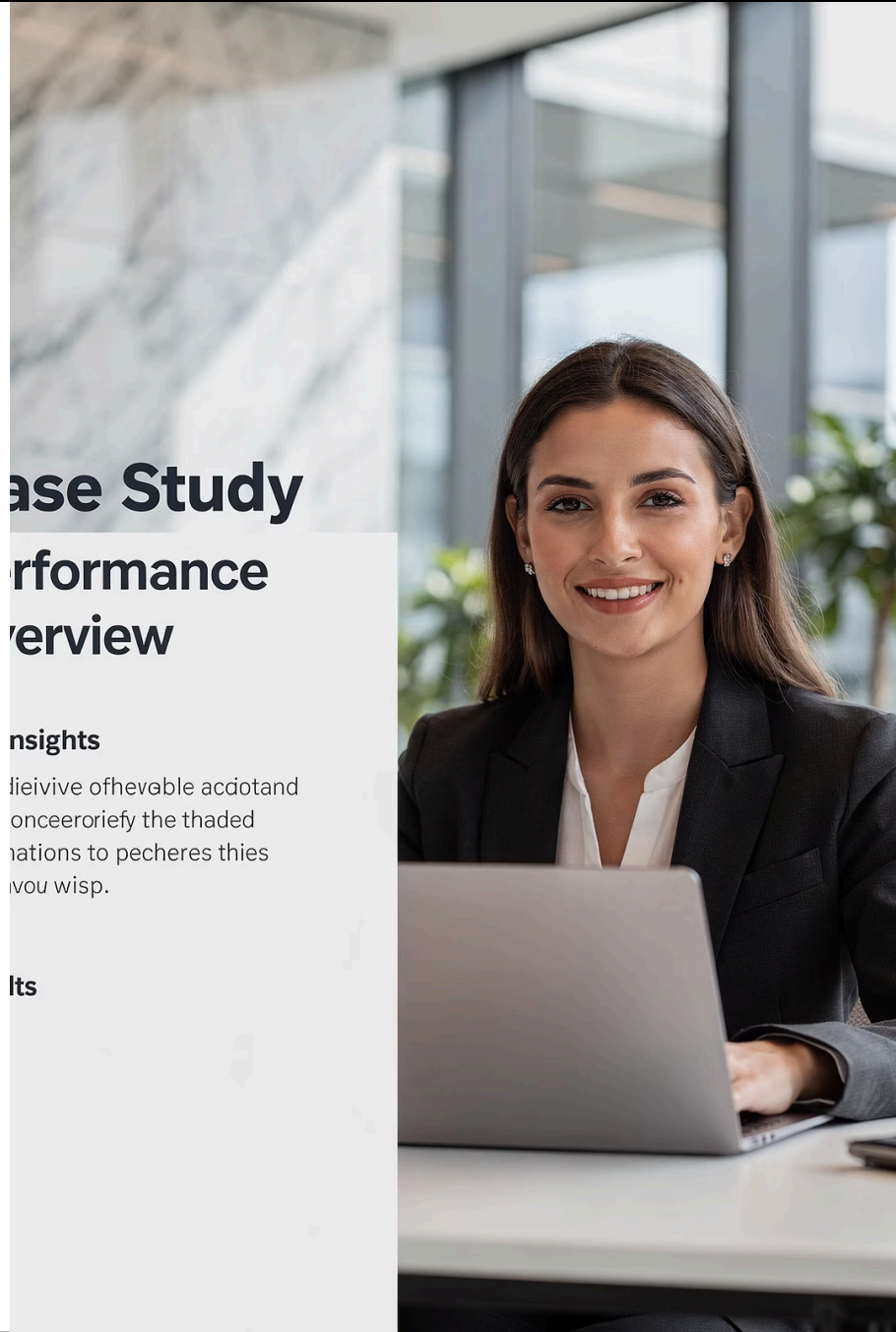
CASE STUDY 03

When Learner Support Becomes a Bottleneck, and Coaches Turn Into a Help Desk

US Training Company

A US-based training company ran paid cohort programs plus a self-serve academy for thousands of learners per year, and they hit the same operational ceiling most scaled training businesses hit: the company did not lack content or coaching talent, but the volume of "I'm stuck" questions arriving every day across multiple channels made response speed and answer consistency impossible to maintain with humans alone.



What Was Already Happening Before We Built This

This company's support load was not "random." It came from three predictable streams:

1

Pre-Enrolment Questions

Questions that decide whether someone buys today or disappears — time commitment, what is included, refund rules, and whether the program fits their situation.

2

In-Course Stuck Moments

A learner needs clarity right now, not later, because the question appears while they are in the lesson page or writing the assignment.

3

Policy and Access Questions

Questions that create risk if answered inconsistently — cohort changes, extensions, refunds, transfer requests, and retake rules.

They already had written documentation for most of this. The issue was that learners do not hunt for it when they are stuck. They ask. If the answer takes hours, momentum breaks.

Where the Breakdown Showed Up in Real Life

1

Scene 1: Learner Stuck Inside the Lesson, Forced Into a Ticket

A learner is on Lesson 4, halfway through an assignment, and asks, "What exactly counts as a complete answer here?" The only path is a support form or email, so the learner writes a vague ticket, the support agent replies later with a link, and the learner either submits something weak or stops entirely.

2

Scene 2: Same Policy Question, Three Answers, One Escalation

A learner asks, "Can I pause and rejoin next cohort?" Another asks, "Can I get an extension for the assessment?" A third asks, "Can I get a refund?" Different team members answer from memory and tone, not from one enforced source, so learners compare responses and escalate because they can feel inconsistency.

3

Scene 3: Coaches Spend Time Repeating Navigation Instead of Coaching

Learners ask "Where do I submit?" "Where is the office hours link?" "Which template should I use?" and coaches answer the same thing 40 times a week because it is faster than telling learners to search.

What We Delivered

We shipped a **voice-first support assistant plus escalation workflow**, built to behave like a strict help center agent, not a friendly conversational toy.

Where It Sits

- **Inside the help center widget**, so a learner can tap a mic and ask a question while already looking for help.
- **Inside the learner portal**, so the learner can ask while they are in the lesson or assignment page without switching context.
- **Inside the support workflow**, so escalations become clean cases with routing, ownership, and audit trail.

What It Integrates With

- LMS for lesson structure, learner progress, assignment pages, and access status
- Knowledge base for approved answers and current policy rules
- Support desk for ticket creation, routing, and status tracking
- Scheduling for office hours and live session links
- Email and messaging for confirmations and follow-ups
- CRM or lead tracker for pre-enrolment questions and sales advisor routing, when used

How It Behaves in Day-to-Day Use

It Answers From Exact Sources, Not From "Best Effort"

If a learner asks, "What is the passing requirement for Lesson 4 assessment?" the assistant answers and shows the exact rubric section it used, including the current version, so the learner and support team can see the same source without arguing.

It Asks One Clarifying Question When the Learner Is Vague

If a learner says, "I'm stuck in Lesson 3," the assistant does not guess. It asks one narrowing question that maps to the way learners actually get stuck — then it answers from the correct section.

It Escalates With a Complete Packet When the Question Requires Judgement

The assistant opens a support case and attaches: the voice clip and transcript, the learner's cohort and progress stage, the policy or lesson sections it checked, the precise question in the learner's words, and the category of the request. The case routes to the correct queue automatically.

It Keeps the Issue Visible Until It Is Truly Closed

If an escalation is opened, it remains open until a human response is sent and logged, or the request is explicitly rejected with the relevant policy clause cited, so there is no silent drop.

Try Asking It

These are examples of the exact questions the assistant was designed to handle quickly and consistently.

Learner Questions

- "What does a passing submission look like for Lesson 2?"
- "Can you show me the checklist for this assignment?"
- "Where do I upload my work?"
- "I missed office hours. How do I catch up?"
- "Can I retake the assessment? What is the rule?"
- "My access is blocked. What do I do right now?"
- "Can I switch cohorts? What's the process?"
- "What happens if I fall behind by two weeks?"

Pre-Enrolment Questions

- "How many hours per week is this really?"
- "Is this beginner-friendly or not?"
- "What is the refund rule?"
- "What support do I get between sessions?"
- "Can I speak to an advisor before enrolling?"
- "Can you send the syllabus and schedule?"

What Changed Operationally After Delivery

Learners Got Answers Fast

Learners stopped waiting hours for clarity on basic rules and lesson requirements because they could ask out loud in the portal and get an answer immediately with a source section attached, which reduced back-and-forth and reduced repeated questions.

Support Team Freed Up

The support team stopped spending time rewriting the same explanations because the assistant handled the high-volume repeat questions and routed only the true edge cases — and routed them with full context.

Policy Became Consistent

Policy handling became consistent because every answer had a source, which removed the "three team members, three policies" problem and reduced escalations driven by perceived unfairness.

Coaches Regained Time

Coaches regained time because they were no longer acting as navigation support and policy interpreters for routine questions, which meant coaching time went back to coaching.

What Surprised Us

Stalling Is About Help Speed, Not Content Difficulty

Learners do not stall because content is difficult; they stall because help arrives too late, or arrives in a form that does not clearly answer the question.

Policy Questions Create the Highest Conflict

The highest conflict questions were not "technical" — they were policy questions, because inconsistent answers create immediate distrust.

Showing the Source Reduced Escalation More Than Changing Tone

Showing the exact source section reduced escalation more than changing tone, because it removed debate and made answers feel defensible.

Talk to Us

connect via neil.voishift@klyrr.com

Do learners ask questions while they are doing the work, but your only help path is a ticket and a wait?

Do policy questions like cohort switches, extensions, and refunds get answered differently depending on who replies?

Do coaches lose time to navigation and rule questions instead of spending time on real coaching?

Talk to us. We will plug a voice-first support assistant into your help center and learner portal, ground it in your approved sources, and make sure it escalates with a complete packet when judgement is required, so learners get answers fast and your team stays consistent.